

LESSON 10: Management and Quality Control in Cataloguing

10.0 Management and Quality Control in Cataloguing

Quality cataloguing implies application of standards or rules of cataloguing to cataloguing practice.

- It requires emphasis on maintenance of cataloguing rules.
- Quality control involves attention to all positions in cataloguing department even to the lowliest, as quality work in one area can be negated by sloppiness in another, for example careless inputting of data.
- The Anglo- American Cataloguing Rules (AACR 2) and presently Resource

Description and Access (RDA) need to be used for standardization in bibliographic

description of information resources.

- Library of Congress Classification Scheme; Dewey Decimal Classification Scheme, Bliss Bibliographic Classification Scheme; Colon Classification Scheme; and Elizabeth Moys classification scheme for law books, among other classification schemes emerged as a result of the quest to maintain standard in classification of information resources.
- In order to have uniformed system of representing bibliographic features of any information resource, different subject heading lists emerged, and the most popular ones are the **Library of Congress Subject Heading List** and **Sears**

List of Subject Headings, and each is used depending on the classification

system adopted by a particular library.

NB:

All the above noted efforts are geared towards making information resources easily accessible and retrievable in order to serve the clientele better and faster.

10.1 Thesaurus: Definition

- Derivationally the word thesaurus originated from the Greek language and symbolized the concept of treasury or storehouse of knowledge. The Webster's dictionary has defined it as, '**a useful literary collection or selection especially a book of synonyms and antonyms.**'
- The UNESCO has defined the thesaurus as, '**a vocabulary of controlled indexing language formally organized so that the a priori relationships between concepts (e.g., 'broader' and 'narrower') are made explicit**'
- A thesaurus is chiefly a terminological control device for transformation of natural language (NL) expressions, used by authors, referees, publishers, indexers and users who form the various links in the information transfer chain into a more constrained system of vocabulary
- A compilation of words and phrases showing synonyms and hierarchical and other relationships and dependencies, the function of which is to provide a standardized vocabulary for information storage and retrieval systems.
- A thesaurus is used **to find words that are interesting to use in place of other words** and is used to make texts that are more interesting. It is used to identify vocabulary that is interesting to utilize in place of other words and is employed to create texts that are more engaging.
- **Functionally a thesaurus is** a terminological control device used in translating the natural language into the systems language. **In any information storage and retrieval system (ISRS), indexing plays an important role. An index describes the**

10.2 Purposes of Thesaurus:

The purposes of the thesaurus are;

- To provide a map of a given field of knowledge.
- To provide a standard vocabulary for a given subject field.
- To provide a system of references between terms.
- To provide a guide for users of the system.
- To locate new concepts in a scheme of relationships with existing concepts in a way which, makes sense to users of the system.
- To provide classified hierarchies.

- To provide means by which the use of terms in given subject field may be standardized.
- The thesaurus can also be used for generation of keyword lists
- The thesaurus is also useful in computer-assisted indexing and abstracting.
- Thesaurus helps in defining terms.
- The thesaurus plays a vital role in retrieving relevant information from an Information Retrieval (IR) System.

10.3 Browsing a Thesaurus or Index

Some databases let you search the subject headings directly. A list of subject headings used in a particular database is often referred to as a thesaurus. They are available through the index or subject search tools. The index displays an alphabetical list of subject headings used in the database. However, some databases have sophisticated thesauri that provide cross-references. For example, if you type in "death penalty," the thesaurus might have an entry that tells you to use "capital punishment" instead. Some thesauri also include a description of the term, and a list of broader, narrower, and related terms.

10.4 Deciphering your results

The results you get from your search depend on the type of database you are searching.

- A **bibliographic database** provides a citation which is a basic description of an article. This usually includes the title of the work, the author, the publisher, the date, the original source, the city of publication, etc., according to the type of item being cited (e.g. book, magazine article, World Wide Web site, etc.)
- A bibliographic database may also provide an abstract - a short summary of the contents of an item in a database.
- A **full-text database** will display an article in its entirety. Full-text articles can appear as HTML documents, in which all the words that appeared in the original print format are offered to you online, or as PDF documents, which show each page as it appears in the print journal or magazine. Non-textual material such as pictures and charts are not always included.